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This document forms part of the official governance framework of the International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) and should be read together with the related documents listed above.

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1. Purpose

The International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) is committed to producing and disseminating high-quality, credible, independent and professionally rigorous publications that contribute to the development of equity research, investment analysis and the broader investment profession.

This Publications and Editorial Policy ("Policy") establishes the principles, standards and governance requirements applicable to publications produced, commissioned, sponsored, edited, reviewed, distributed or otherwise issued by ISEA.

ISEA recognises that its publications may materially contribute to professional knowledge, influence investment and research practices, and shape the reputation of ISEA and the equity analysis profession. Accordingly, ISEA is committed to ensuring that its publications are developed with appropriate editorial independence, intellectual integrity, transparency, accuracy and professional judgement.

ISEA's publications may include, but are not limited to:

- (a) the International Journal of Equity Analysts, published quarterly as ISEA's principal scholarly and professional journal;
- (b) Global Market Outlook Reports, published monthly;
- (c) White Papers;
- (d) Occasional Research Papers;
- (e) research reports and analytical studies;
- (f) professional guidance and technical publications;
- (g) conference and event publications;
- (h) educational publications;
- (i) policy papers and consultation documents; and
- (j) other publications approved or issued by ISEA.

This Policy is intended to:

- (k) establish standards for editorial independence and integrity;
- (l) establish appropriate peer review and editorial review processes;
- (m) establish requirements for authors and contributors;
- (n) ensure appropriate disclosure of conflicts of interest and relevant relationships;
- (o) establish procedures for corrections, retractions and other post-publication actions;
- (p) protect publications against plagiarism, fabrication, falsification and other forms of intellectual misconduct;
- (q) establish appropriate requirements for the use of artificial intelligence and other technology in publication development;
- (r) distinguish editorial content from sponsored content and advertising;
- (s) establish safeguards against editorial conflicts;
- (t) regulate the appropriate use of ISEA's name, marks and institutional identity in connection with publications; and
- (u) maintain appropriate disclaimers concerning the nature, purpose and limitations of ISEA publications.

This Policy operates alongside the ISEA Charter, Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct, Ethics Policy, Conflict of Interest Policy, Complaints Policy, Disciplinary Policy, Whistleblower Policy and other applicable ISEA policies, regulations and governance requirements.

2. Scope and Application

This Policy applies to all ISEA publications and publication-related activities, regardless of format or medium, including print, electronic, digital, online and other forms of dissemination.

It applies to:

- (a) the Governing Council;
- (b) the Secretary-General and Executive Secretariat;
- (c) members of the Editorial Board and editorial teams;
- (d) editors, associate editors and guest editors;
- (e) peer reviewers and other reviewers;
- (f) authors, co-authors and contributors;
- (g) research providers and external researchers engaged by ISEA;
- (h) committee members and other persons contributing to publications on behalf of ISEA;
- (i) employees, consultants, contractors and volunteers involved in publication activities;
- (j) sponsors and commercial partners to the extent that they participate in or support publication activities; and
- (k) any other person involved in preparing, reviewing, approving, editing, publishing, sponsoring or distributing ISEA publications.

This Policy applies to original content, commissioned content, contributed content, adapted content, reproduced material and content generated or assisted by artificial intelligence or other technological tools.

Where a particular publication has additional editorial, academic, professional or methodological requirements, those requirements shall apply in addition to this Policy.

3. Publications Covered by this Policy

ISEA may publish different categories of material for different professional, research, educational and institutional purposes.

3.1 International Journal of Equity Analysts

The International Journal of Equity Analysts (“Journal”) is ISEA's principal scholarly and professional publication.

The Journal shall seek to promote rigorous research, professional knowledge, analytical development and informed discussion concerning equity research, investment analysis, financial markets, valuation and related disciplines.

The Journal shall ordinarily be published quarterly.

ISEA may establish separate editorial guidelines governing submission, peer review, publication standards, authorship and other Journal-specific matters, provided that such guidelines are consistent with this Policy.

3.2 Global Market Outlook Reports

Global Market Outlook Reports are ISEA's periodic market-oriented publications intended to provide professional analysis, commentary, observations and perspectives concerning relevant developments in global financial markets and the investment environment.

The Reports shall ordinarily be published monthly.

The Reports shall clearly distinguish analytical observations, factual information, forecasts, assumptions and opinions where appropriate.

3.3 White Papers

White Papers may be published occasionally to examine significant professional, technical, policy, methodological or industry issues relevant to equity research and investment analysis.

White Papers should ordinarily identify their purpose, methodology, sources and principal contributors.

3.4 Occasional Research Papers

ISEA may publish Occasional Research Papers addressing specific research questions, emerging issues, analytical methodologies or other matters relevant to the profession.

The level of review applicable to an Occasional Research Paper shall be determined having regard to its purpose, subject matter, intended audience and level of analytical or scholarly content.

3.5 Other Publications

ISEA may publish other materials, including professional guidance, technical notes, conference materials, educational resources, consultation papers and institutional reports.

The Secretary-General or designated editorial authority may establish appropriate review and approval requirements for such publications.

4. Editorial Independence

ISEA shall maintain editorial independence in the development, review, approval and publication of its editorial and research content.

Editorial decisions shall be based on appropriate professional, scholarly, analytical and editorial considerations and shall not be improperly influenced by:

- (a) sponsors;
- (b) advertisers;
- (c) commercial partners;
- (d) research providers;
- (e) Members;
- (f) companies or issuers;
- (g) financial institutions;
- (h) authors or contributors;
- (i) donors or other funding sources; or
- (j) other external or internal interests.

Editorial independence includes the authority to determine:

- (k) whether material is suitable for publication;
- (l) the editorial treatment of material;
- (m) whether material requires revision;
- (n) the selection of reviewers;
- (o) the acceptance or rejection of submissions;
- (p) corrections or other post-publication actions; and
- (q) the timing and manner of publication.

Financial or commercial support for a publication must not create an entitlement to editorial control or preferential treatment.

ISEA shall seek to maintain a clear separation between editorial decision-making and commercial, sponsorship and advertising functions.

5. Editorial Governance

ISEA may establish an Editorial Board, editorial committee or other appropriate editorial body to oversee publications.

The responsibilities of the relevant editorial authority may include:

- (a) establishing editorial standards;
- (b) approving publication processes;

- (c) overseeing editorial quality;
- (d) appointing or approving editors and reviewers;
- (e) overseeing peer review;
- (f) managing editorial conflicts;
- (g) reviewing significant complaints concerning publications;
- (h) recommending corrections or retractions;
- (i) monitoring publication integrity;
- (j) recommending improvements to publication processes; and
- (k) ensuring consistency with this Policy and other applicable ISEA requirements.

The editorial authority shall operate subject to the authority of the Governing Council and applicable ISEA governance documents.

Editorial decisions should, where practicable, be made independently of persons who have a material personal or commercial interest in the outcome.

6. Peer Review

Where a publication is intended to constitute scholarly or substantive research, ISEA should apply an appropriate peer review process.

The International Journal of Equity Analysts shall ordinarily be subject to peer review in accordance with the Journal's editorial requirements.

Peer review may involve:

- (a) assessment of methodological quality;
- (b) assessment of analytical reasoning;
- (c) assessment of the quality and adequacy of evidence;
- (d) assessment of originality or contribution;
- (e) review of citations and sources;
- (f) assessment of clarity and coherence;
- (g) identification of material limitations; and
- (h) other review appropriate to the nature of the submission.

ISEA may use single-blind, double-blind, open or other appropriate review models depending on the publication and circumstances.

Peer reviewers shall:

- (i) act objectively and professionally;
- (j) maintain confidentiality;
- (k) disclose relevant conflicts of interest;
- (l) avoid using unpublished material for personal advantage;
- (m) provide constructive and evidence-based comments; and
- (n) decline a review where they cannot provide an appropriately independent assessment.

Peer review does not guarantee publication and does not transfer responsibility for the integrity of the work from the author to the reviewer.

7. Author and Contributor Requirements

Authors and contributors are responsible for ensuring that submitted material is accurate, original, appropriately sourced and consistent with applicable professional and ethical standards.

Authors must:

- (a) ensure that submitted material is their original work or that they have appropriate authority to use the material;
- (b) accurately represent research methods, evidence, analysis and conclusions;
- (c) properly acknowledge sources and contributions;
- (d) disclose material conflicts of interest;
- (e) disclose relevant financial, professional, institutional or commercial relationships;
- (f) identify material limitations, assumptions and uncertainties where appropriate;
- (g) cooperate with reasonable editorial and review processes;
- (h) respond appropriately to requests for clarification or supporting information;
- (i) notify ISEA promptly where a material error is discovered after publication; and
- (j) comply with applicable ISEA policies and publication requirements.

Authors must not submit or publish material that is knowingly fabricated, falsified, plagiarised, materially misleading or otherwise professionally inappropriate.

Where multiple authors contribute to a publication, the authors should agree upon authorship and identify their respective contributions where appropriate.

Individuals who have made only minor editorial, administrative or technical contributions should not ordinarily be represented as authors solely on that basis.

8. Research Integrity and Accuracy

ISEA expects all research and analytical publications to be prepared with appropriate intellectual and professional integrity.

Authors and contributors must take reasonable steps to ensure that:

- (a) factual statements are supported by reliable sources;
- (b) data are accurately presented;
- (c) calculations and analytical methods are appropriately applied;
- (d) material assumptions are identified;
- (e) research methodologies are described accurately where relevant;
- (f) quotations and reproduced materials are appropriately attributed;
- (g) limitations are not deliberately concealed; and
- (h) conclusions are not materially misrepresented.

ISEA may request supporting data, research materials, methodological information or other evidence where reasonably necessary to assess the integrity of a publication.

9. Conflicts of Interest and Disclosure

Authors, editors, reviewers and other persons materially involved in publication decisions must disclose actual, potential and relevant perceived conflicts of interest.

Potential conflicts may include:

- (a) financial interests in a company or security discussed in a publication;
- (b) employment or consultancy relationships;
- (c) investment or commercial relationships;
- (d) sponsorship or funding relationships;
- (e) personal or professional relationships with authors or subjects of research;
- (f) relationships with companies, issuers or financial institutions discussed in a publication;
- (g) competing research or commercial interests; and

(h) any other circumstance that could reasonably affect, or appear to affect, independent judgement.

Disclosures should be sufficiently clear to allow readers to understand the nature and significance of the relevant relationship.

Where a conflict cannot appropriately be managed, ISEA may require the person to:

- (i) recuse themselves;
- (j) withdraw from the editorial or review process;
- (k) appoint an alternative reviewer or editor;
- (l) include an appropriate disclosure; or
- (m) take another appropriate measure.

The existence of a disclosed conflict does not necessarily prevent publication. The relevant consideration is whether the conflict can be appropriately managed while preserving editorial integrity and reader transparency.

10. Editorial Conflicts

Editors and editorial decision-makers must exercise independent professional judgement.

An editor must not participate in a decision where the editor has a material personal, professional, financial or commercial interest that could reasonably compromise or appear to compromise independence.

Editorial conflicts may arise where:

- (a) the editor is an author or co-author;
- (b) the editor has a close personal or professional relationship with an author;
- (c) the editor has a significant financial interest relevant to the publication;
- (d) the editor has a competing commercial or academic interest;
- (e) the editor has a material relationship with an organisation discussed in the publication; or
- (f) other circumstances exist that could reasonably call editorial independence into question.

Where an editorial conflict exists, the affected editor should disclose the conflict and, where appropriate, recuse themselves from the relevant decision.

ISEA may appoint an alternative editor or decision-maker where necessary.

11. Plagiarism and Intellectual Misconduct

ISEA does not tolerate plagiarism, fabrication, falsification, material misrepresentation or other forms of intellectual misconduct.

Plagiarism includes presenting another person's ideas, words, data, research, analysis, images or other intellectual work as one's own without appropriate attribution.

Plagiarism may include:

- (a) direct copying without appropriate attribution;
- (b) substantial paraphrasing without attribution;
- (c) presenting another person's research or ideas as original;
- (d) inappropriate reuse of previously published material;
- (e) undisclosed duplicate publication; and
- (f) other conduct that materially misrepresents authorship or originality.

Where plagiarism or other intellectual misconduct is suspected, ISEA may undertake an appropriate review or investigation.

Depending on the circumstances, ISEA may:

- (g) request clarification or supporting information;
- (h) require correction of the publication;
- (i) reject or withdraw a submission;
- (j) suspend publication;
- (k) issue a correction or retraction;
- (l) notify relevant institutions or professional bodies where appropriate;
- (m) restrict future publication opportunities; or
- (n) take disciplinary or other action under applicable ISEA requirements.

12. AI-Assisted Content

ISEA recognises that artificial intelligence, machine learning, automated research systems and other technologies may assist authors, researchers, editors and other contributors.

The use of artificial intelligence does not transfer responsibility for the accuracy, integrity, originality or professional judgement reflected in a publication.

Authors and contributors remain responsible for all material submitted to ISEA, including material generated or assisted by artificial intelligence.

AI systems must not be treated as independent authors.

Where artificial intelligence has been used in a material way in the preparation of a publication, ISEA may require disclosure of:

- (a) the AI system or tool used;
- (b) the purpose for which it was used;
- (c) the nature and extent of its contribution; and
- (d) any relevant verification or validation undertaken by the author.

AI-generated material must be appropriately reviewed and verified before publication.

Authors must take particular care to identify and correct:

- (e) fabricated information;
- (f) inaccurate citations;
- (g) unsupported claims;
- (h) misleading summaries;
- (i) invented sources;
- (j) biased or distorted outputs; and
- (k) other errors arising from the use of AI systems.

Confidential, personal, proprietary or otherwise protected information must not be entered into an AI system where doing so would breach applicable confidentiality, privacy, contractual or legal obligations.

ISEA may establish additional AI-use requirements as technology and professional practice develop.

13. Corrections and Amendments

ISEA is committed to correcting material errors in its publications in a timely and transparent manner.

A correction may be appropriate where a published work contains:

- (a) a factual error;
- (b) a material calculation error;
- (c) an inaccurate attribution;
- (d) an incomplete or inaccurate disclosure;

- (e) an editorial error that materially affects understanding; or
- (f) another error that should reasonably be corrected.

The form and prominence of a correction shall be proportionate to the nature and significance of the error.

Where practicable, the original publication should remain identifiable and the correction should clearly explain the nature of the amendment.

Minor typographical, formatting or editorial errors that do not materially affect meaning may be corrected without issuing a formal correction notice.

ISEA may also amend digital publications where necessary to correct non-material errors, provided that material changes are appropriately documented.

14. Retractions and Withdrawal

ISEA may retract or withdraw a publication where continued publication would materially undermine the integrity, accuracy or credibility of the publication or ISEA.

Grounds for retraction or withdrawal may include:

- (a) substantial plagiarism;
- (b) fabrication or falsification of data or research;
- (c) material research misconduct;
- (d) serious undisclosed conflicts of interest;
- (e) publication based on materially unreliable or fraudulent information;
- (f) significant legal or intellectual property concerns;
- (g) serious ethical violations;
- (h) material duplication or unauthorised republication; or
- (i) other circumstances that make continued reliance on the publication inappropriate.

A retraction decision should be based on a fair and appropriately documented review of the circumstances.

Where practicable, a retracted publication should remain identifiable as a retracted publication rather than being silently removed, unless legal, safety, privacy or other compelling considerations require removal.

A retraction notice should identify the publication concerned and provide an appropriate explanation for the retraction.

15. Sponsored Content

ISEA may publish or distribute sponsored content where doing so is consistent with its professional purpose and editorial standards.

Sponsored content must be clearly identified as sponsored, paid, commissioned or otherwise commercially supported.

Sponsorship must not give the sponsor editorial control over independent ISEA research or editorial content.

Sponsors must not be permitted to:

- (a) require a predetermined research conclusion;
- (b) suppress material findings;
- (c) require favourable treatment of a company, security or industry;
- (d) interfere with peer review;
- (e) select or remove independent reviewers solely to influence an outcome;

- (f) alter independent editorial conclusions; or
- (g) otherwise compromise editorial independence.

Where sponsored research or content is published, the nature of the sponsorship or funding relationship should be disclosed clearly and prominently.

16. Advertising

ISEA may accept advertising in publications or associated publication platforms where the advertising is consistent with ISEA's values, professional standards and reputation.

Advertising decisions should be separate from editorial decisions.

ISEA shall not accept advertising that:

- (a) is unlawful;
- (b) is materially misleading or deceptive;
- (c) is inconsistent with ISEA's professional standards;
- (d) creates a material conflict with the publication's purpose;
- (e) implies endorsement by ISEA without authorisation;
- (f) improperly uses ISEA's name, marks or professional standing; or
- (g) otherwise presents an unacceptable reputational or ethical risk.

Advertisements should be clearly distinguishable from editorial content.

Acceptance of advertising does not constitute endorsement by ISEA of the advertiser, its products, services, securities, investment strategies or claims.

17. Separation of Editorial and Commercial Functions

ISEA shall seek to maintain appropriate separation between:

- (a) editorial decision-making;
- (b) research and analytical activities;
- (c) sponsorship;
- (d) advertising;
- (e) commercial partnerships; and
- (f) other revenue-generating activities.

Persons responsible for commercial relationships should not improperly influence editorial decisions. Similarly, editors and researchers should not use editorial authority to obtain personal or commercial benefits.

Where structural separation is not practicable because of ISEA's size or organisational arrangements, appropriate disclosure, recusal, review or other safeguards should be implemented.

18. Use of ISEA's Name, Logo and Institutional Identity

ISEA's name, logo, trademarks, professional designations and institutional identity may only be used in connection with publications in accordance with ISEA's authorisation and applicable branding requirements.

Authors, Members, sponsors, partners and other persons must not represent that a publication:

- (a) has been issued by ISEA;
- (b) has been endorsed by ISEA;
- (c) has been reviewed or approved by ISEA;
- (d) represents an official ISEA position; or
- (e) carries ISEA's institutional authority,

unless such representation is accurate and expressly authorised.

Use of the ISEA name in a publication does not, by itself, constitute endorsement of every statement, conclusion, recommendation or opinion contained in that publication.

Persons must not use ISEA's name, logo or institutional identity in a manner that could reasonably mislead readers concerning ISEA's involvement, endorsement or responsibility.

19. Disclaimers

ISEA publications should include an appropriate disclaimer having regard to the nature and purpose of the publication.

Where applicable, disclaimers should make clear that:

- (a) publications are provided for informational, educational, research or professional purposes;
- (b) publications do not constitute personalised investment, financial, legal, accounting or other professional advice;
- (c) opinions and forecasts are those of the relevant authors or contributors unless expressly stated otherwise;
- (d) forecasts and forward-looking statements are subject to uncertainty and may not materialise;
- (e) readers should undertake their own assessment and obtain appropriate professional advice where necessary;
- (f) publication does not constitute an offer, solicitation or recommendation to buy or sell a security unless expressly and appropriately authorised;
- (g) ISEA does not guarantee the completeness or accuracy of all information where appropriate; and
- (h) past performance is not necessarily indicative of future results, where relevant.

Disclaimers must not be used to excuse deliberate inaccuracies, misleading statements, research misconduct or failure to comply with applicable professional standards.

20. Complaints Concerning Publications

ISEA may receive complaints or concerns concerning the accuracy, integrity, authorship, editorial independence, conflicts of interest or other aspects of an ISEA publication.

Publication-related complaints shall be handled in accordance with the ISEA Complaints Policy where applicable.

Where a complaint raises potential plagiarism, research misconduct, undisclosed conflicts, professional misconduct or other serious concerns, ISEA may refer the matter to the appropriate governance, ethics or disciplinary process.

ISEA shall seek to ensure that publication-related complaints are considered fairly, appropriately and without improper interference with editorial independence.

21. Confidentiality

Editors, reviewers, authors, researchers and other persons involved in publication processes shall maintain appropriate confidentiality concerning unpublished manuscripts, research materials, peer review comments, editorial deliberations and other confidential information.

Confidential information must not be used for personal, commercial or other improper advantage.

Information may be disclosed where:

- (a) required by law;
- (b) necessary for the proper administration of the publication process;
- (c) necessary to investigate suspected misconduct;
- (d) authorised by the relevant editorial or governance authority; or

- (e) otherwise permitted under applicable ISEA requirements.

22. Records and Publication Integrity

ISEA shall maintain appropriate records concerning its publications and material editorial decisions.

Records may include:

- (a) submitted manuscripts;
- (b) review records;
- (c) editorial decisions;
- (d) author disclosures;
- (e) conflict-of-interest declarations;
- (f) sponsorship and funding disclosures;
- (g) correction and retraction records;
- (h) relevant correspondence; and
- (i) other records reasonably necessary to demonstrate the integrity of the publication process.

ISEA shall seek to maintain sufficient records to support accountability, transparency and the appropriate administration of its publication activities.

23. Responsibilities

23.1 Governing Council

The Governing Council is responsible for oversight of ISEA's publication framework and shall approve this Policy and material amendments.

The Governing Council may establish or designate an editorial authority responsible for implementing this Policy.

23.2 Secretary-General and Executive Secretariat

The Secretary-General and Executive Secretariat shall support the administration of ISEA's publication framework and may:

- (a) coordinate publication processes;
- (b) maintain publication records;
- (c) support editorial governance;
- (d) facilitate disclosures and conflict management;
- (e) coordinate publication of approved materials; and
- (f) escalate significant matters to the appropriate authority.

23.3 Editorial Board and Editors

The Editorial Board and editors are responsible for maintaining editorial standards and independence within their respective publications.

They shall exercise appropriate professional judgement and ensure that publication decisions are made consistently with this Policy.

23.4 Authors and Contributors

Authors and contributors are responsible for the accuracy, integrity, originality and appropriate disclosure of their work.

23.5 Peer Reviewers

Peer reviewers are responsible for providing independent, confidential and professionally appropriate assessments and for disclosing relevant conflicts.

24. Relationship with Other ISEA Requirements

This Policy should be read together with the ISEA Charter, Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct, Ethics Policy, Conflict of Interest Policy, Complaints Policy, Disciplinary Policy, Whistleblower Policy, Gifts, Benefits and Hospitality Policy and other applicable ISEA requirements.

The Code establishes the ethical and professional standards applicable to persons within its scope.

The Conflict of Interest Policy establishes requirements for identifying, disclosing and managing conflicts that may arise in connection with publication activities.

The Complaints Policy establishes procedures for receiving and handling complaints concerning ISEA and persons subject to ISEA requirements.

The Disciplinary Policy establishes procedures for addressing alleged breaches of ISEA requirements.

Where another ISEA document establishes a more specific requirement concerning a particular publication or activity, that requirement shall apply in addition to this Policy.

Where any inconsistency exists between this Policy and a higher-ranking ISEA governing document, the higher-ranking document shall prevail.

25. Review and Continuous Improvement

ISEA shall periodically review this Publications and Editorial Policy and its broader publication framework to ensure that they remain appropriate, effective and consistent with evolving professional standards.

The review shall have regard to:

- (a) developments in scholarly and professional publishing;
- (b) developments in equity research and investment analysis;
- (c) emerging standards concerning research integrity and publication ethics;
- (d) developments in artificial intelligence and other publication technologies;
- (e) changes in ISEA's publication portfolio;
- (f) experience arising from peer review, editorial processes, corrections and retractions;
- (g) emerging conflicts-of-interest risks;
- (h) regulatory and legal developments;
- (i) feedback from authors, reviewers, Members and other relevant stakeholders; and
- (j) international publishing and professional practices.

The relevant editorial authority or Committee may recommend amendments to this Policy, subject to approval by the Governing Council.

26. Effective Date

This Publications and Editorial Policy takes effect on the date approved by the Governing Council.